

Homework 3, Week 4

Activities

Activity 5

ACTIVITY 5

Below are introductory paragraphs of four process essays. Are they more likely to be directional process or informative process? Write down your answer on the line provided.

1. Freewriting is a brainstorming technique made famous by Peter Elbow in two very fine books, *Writing Without Teachers* and *Writing with Power*. It's a language-spinning machine that you can point at lots of different kinds of writing—a kind of spigot you can turn on to tap into some of your ideas and feelings.

Process analysis: _____

2. When I began writing this book on my word processor I didn't have any idea what would happen. Would I be able to write anything at all? Would it be any good? I was bringing to the machine what I assumed were wholly different ways of thinking about writing. The units massed in front of me looked cold and sterile. Their steady hum reminded me that they were waiting. They seemed to be waiting for information, not for writing. Maybe what I wrote would also be cold and sterile.

Process analysis: _____

3. One writing teacher compares the task of a writer to that of a tour guide escorting a group of sightseers who do not have to pay their fares until they arrive at their destination and get off the bus. The job of both the author and the tour guide requires that they keep their audiences so interested in what is going on that they will stay until the end of the journey. Readers, like tourists, are capricious and impatient, and they will go off and do something else if they get confused, bored, or led off on a detour that seems pointless to them. When you write, you may find

it helpful to keep this analogy in mind and from time to time ask yourself, “Are my readers liable to get off the bus here?” And writers, like tour guides, must keep their audiences oriented. If there is any way for readers to get lost, they will!

All writers need to keep this caution in mind as they write (especially their second or third drafts) and to work consciously to help their readers stay on track as they are reading. Once they stray, they are hard to recapture. For that reason, a writer needs to have some specific strategies to hold readers’ attention.

Process analysis: _____

4. I have been asked to write something for a textbook that is meant to teach college students something about writing and revision. I am happy to do this because I believe in revision. I have also been asked to save the early drafts of whatever I write, presumably to show these students the actual process of revision. This is something which I am also happy to do. On the other hand I suspect that there is just so much you can teach college students about revision; a gift for revision may be a developmental stage—like a 2-year-old’s sudden ability to place one block on top of another—that comes along somewhat later, in one’s mid-20s, say; most people may not be particularly good at it, or even interested in it, until then.

When I was in college, I revised nothing. I wrote out my papers in longhand...

Process analysis: _____

1. Informative process. It states what is freewriting.
2. Informative process. It discusses what the writing should be.
3. Directional process. It shows how the writers hold reader's attention.
4. Directional process. It states how to teach college students something about writing and revision.

Activity 6

ACTIVITY 6

Identify the writing strategies in each of the following passages. Some passages may use more than one strategy.

Using time signals

Explaining the purpose

Defining unfamiliar terms

Anticipating difficulties and problems

Warning the readers what not to do

1. Free writing is a little like running, and you'll lose energy if you start out too fast. But don't go too slow, either, or you'll lose the energy of the words tumbling out and the momentum that builds... The main thing is not to reread what you've written but to plunge ahead. That's surprisingly hard for most of us since we've been

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trained by years of school to be proper and not make a mess, especially in writing. But resist those impulses. Turn off the light on the screen and even write blind if you have to, just don't worry about grammar and punctuation and eloquence or anything else. Let the words flow out. Don't let your fingers leave the keys. Don't correct.

Main strategy: _____

2. If a page or two of free writing turns out to be awful, throw it away and go on. Think of the writing as a warm-up for whatever conventional writing you have to do that day. In fact, it's a mistake to aim for good or workable free writing each time you sit down at the screen. That attitude only reproduces the kinds of pressure that free writing is trying to subvert.

Main strategy: _____

3. Titles play a crucial part in getting off to a good start with your readers. In fact, your prospective readers will often decide whether or not to read what you write primarily on the information you give them in the title. That is why it's so important that your title is clear, accurate, and if possible, interesting. It should also perform some very specific functions.

Main strategy: _____

4. Writing that is highly readable has a quality called linearity; that is, the readers can move steadily through it in a straight line without having to stop to puzzle about what the writer means or double back to reread. Achieving this quality in your writing isn't easy, but it's a goal worth striving for if you want to hold your readers' attention.

Main strategy: _____

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5. Now that we know the focus, the readers, the form and structure, we must make sure that we have the evidence to support that meaning. We should not depend on one form of evidence but have as much variety as possible within the traditions of the genre in which we are writing.

Main strategy: _____

1. Defining unfamiliar terms like free writing, warning the readers what not to do in the process and anticipating difficulties and problems when free writing.

2. Explaining the purpose of the free writing and warning the readers what not to do about the attitude to the free writing.
 3. Explaining the purpose of writing a great title.
 4. Defining unfamiliar terms like linearity and explaining the purpose of ensuring the linearity.
 5. Using the time signals and warning the readers what not to do when searching for the evidence to support the meaning.
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Activity 10

ACTIVITY 10

For each thesis statement below, single-underline the topic and double-underline the main point that the writer wants to express about the topic.

1. Three pleasant ways to spend time during a rainy weekend are to write letters to old friends, read a mystery novel, and play cards.
 2. Watching television is a waste of time.
 3. New Zealand is a place where you can find some of the most beautiful sights you will ever see.
 4. Communicating in a foreign language can create some embarrassing misunderstandings.
 5. Television commercials are deceiving.
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6. The laser was one of the most important inventions in the last century in terms of improving our quality of life.
 7. For an international student, the first day on campus can be confusing.
 8. The traffic conditions in our city are terrible.
 9. Dangerous chemical substances are polluting our water supplies.
 10. Deception is the most fascinating means for animals to protect themselves.
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Activity 11

ACTIVITY II

Identify each of the following thesis statements as effective or weak and mark them as follows. You may identify more than one problem with some statements. Then, write a more effective thesis for the weak ones in the spaces provided.

E = effective

TB = too broad

TN = too narrow

NC = not clear

MO = more than one idea

MA = making announcement

1. Popular culture from foreign countries has influenced Chinese teenagers in many ways.

2. About 20 percent of high school graduates in my city plan to go to universities abroad.

3. Fear of the dark has made my life miserable.

4. This essay will discuss the people you meet in the university library.

5. Students have different opinions on whether they should be allowed to choose their roommates, and some of them seem reasonable to me.

6. The proposed national park will protect many endangered species, and it is time to slow down urbanization.

7. The subject of this paper is loneliness.

8. Many people like to read.

9. The advantages of joining a student association far outweigh the disadvantages.

10. Modern life makes people suspicious and unfriendly.

11. Smoking can be hazardous to a person's health, and it is also very unpleasant to watch someone smoking.

12. Whether students should be allowed to use their laptops during class is a controversial issue in many universities.

1. TB

The popular culture from Japan has influenced Chinese teenagers in both thinking and entertaining ways.

2. TN

About 20 percent of high school graduates in my city plan to go to universities abroad for many different reasons.

3. E

4. MA

You can learn about many types people you meet in the university library from the following article.

5. NC

Some students think they should be allowed to choose their roommates but some have different opinions on it.

6. MO

The proposed national park will protect many endangered species.

7. MA

You will have a thorough understanding about loneliness from the article.

8. TN

Many people like to read for gaining knowledge, entertaining themselves and so on.

9. E

10. TB

The electronic products and the rapid development in modern life make people suspicious

and unfriendly.

11. MO

Smoking can be hazardous to a person's health.

12. E

Text A

Source Text and Paragraph Analysis

Writing Drafts

Richard Marius

1. Finally the moment comes when you sit down to begin your first draft. It is always a good idea at the start to list the points you want to cover. A list is not as **elaborate** as a formal outline. In writing your first list, don't bother to set items down in the order of importance. List your main points and trust your mind to organize them. You will probably make one list, study it, make another, study it, and perhaps make another. You can organize each list more completely than the last. This **preliminary** process may save you hours of starting and stopping. ***(Suggest listing the points as the start of writing draft and explain what the list should be)***
2. Write with your list outline in front of you. Once you begin to write, commit yourself to the task at hand. Do not get up until you have written for an hour. Write your thoughts quickly. Let one sentence give you an idea to develop in the next. Organization, grammar, spelling, and even clarity of sentences are not nearly as important as getting the first draft together. No matter how desperate you feel, keep going. ***(State the following steps after making the list, that is, keep going to ensure the fluency rather than details)***
3. Always keep your mind open to new ideas that pop into your head as you write. Let your list outline help you, but don't become a **slave** to it. Writers often start an essay with one topic in mind only to discover that another pushes the first one aside as they work. Ideas you had not even thought of before you began to write may pile onto your paper, and five or six pages into your first draft you may realize that you are going to write about something you did not imagine when you started. ***(Emphasize the importance of the new idea that is different from the starting when writing)***
4. If such a **revelation** comes, be grateful and accept it. But don't immediately tear up or erase your draft and start all over again. Make yourself keep on writing, developing these new ideas as they come. If you suddenly start all over again, you may break the train of thought that has given you the new topic. Let your thoughts follow your new thesis, sailing on that

tack until the wind changes. ***(State the correct response to the revelation rather than start all over again)***

5. When you have said everything you can say in this draft, print it out if you are working on a computer. Get up from your desk and go sit in a chair somewhere else to read it without correcting anything. Then put it aside, preferably overnight. If possible, read your rough draft just before you go to sleep. Many psychological tests have shown that our minds organize and create while we sleep if we pack them full before bedtime. Study a draft just before sleep, and you may discover new ideas in the morning. ***(The incidents we need to do after the first rough draft)***
6. Be willing to make radical changes in your second draft. If your thesis changed while you were writing your first draft, you will base your second draft on this new subject. Even if your thesis has not changed, you may need to shift paragraphs around, eliminate paragraphs, or add new ones. Inexperienced writers often suppose that revising a paper means changing only a word or two or adding a sentence or two. This kind of editing is part of the writing process, but it is not the most important part. The most important part of rewriting is a willingness to turn the paper upside down, to shake out of it those ideas that interest you most, and to set them in a form where they will interest the reader too. ***(Emphasize the radical changes should be done in the second draft and some details)***
7. Some writers cut up their first drafts with a pair of scissors. They **toss** some paragraphs into the trash; others they paste up with rubber **cement** in the order that seems most logical and **coherent**. Afterward they type the whole thing through again, smoothing out the transitions, adding new material, getting new ideas as they work. The translation of the first draft into the second nearly always involves radical cutting and shifting around. Now and then you may firmly fix the order of your thoughts in your first draft, but I find that the order of my essays is seldom established until the second draft. ***(The other changes we should do in the second draft)***
8. With the **advent** of computers the shifting around of parts of the essays has become easy. We can cut and paste electronically with a few strokes of the keyboard. We can also make back - up copies of our earlier drafts so we can go back to them if we wish. But as I said earlier, computers do not remove from us the necessity to think hard about revising. ***(State the advantage of computer to change the essay but express computer will influence our thoughts)***
9. Always be firm enough with yourself to cut out thoughts or stories that have nothing to do with your thesis, even if they are interesting. Cutting is the supreme test of a writer. You may create a **smashing** paragraph or sentence only to discover later that it does not help you make your point. You may develop six or seven examples to illustrate a point and discover you need only one. ***(Emphasize the significance of firmly cutting out unnecessary thoughts)***
10. Now and then you may **digress** a little. If you digress too often, or too far, readers will not follow you unless your facts, your thoughts, and your style are so **compelling** that they are

somehow driven to follow you. Not many writers can pull such digressions off, and most editors will cut out the digressions even when they are interesting. In our hurried and harried time, most readers get impatient with the **rambling** scenic route. They want to take the most direct way to their destination. To appeal to most of them, you must cut things that do not apply to your main argument. ***(Cut out the digression in case readers lose patience and ensure readers on the right direction)***

11. In your third draft, you can sharpen sentences, add information here and there, cut some things, and attend to other details to heighten the force of your writing. In the third draft, writing becomes a lot of fun (for most of us). By then you have usually decided what you want to say. You can now **play a bit**, finding just the right word, choosing just the right sentence form, compressing here, expanding there. ***(Introduce the detailed things that we do in the third draft)***
12. I find it helpful to put a printed draft down beside my keyboard and type the whole thing through again as a final draft, letting all the words run through my mind and fingers one more time rather than merely deleting and inserting on the computer screen. I wrote four drafts of the first edition of this book; I have preserved the final draft of that edition on computer **diskettes**. But I am writing this draft by **propping** the first edition up here beside me and typing it all over again. By comparing the first draft and the second draft, one can see how many changes I have made, most of them unforeseen until I sat down here to work. ***(The habits of the author that typing the final edition with glancing the former editions to find what revisions are made)***
13. I have outlined here my own writing process. It works for me. You must find the process that works for you. It may be different from mine. A friend tells me that his writing process consists of writing a sentence, agonizing over it, walking around the room, thinking, sitting down, and writing the next sentence. He does not revise very much. I think it unnecessarily painful to bleed out **prose** that way, but he bleeds out enough to write what he needs to write. Several of my friends tell me they cannot compose at a typewriter; they must first write with a pencil on a yellow pad. These are the people most likely to cut up their drafts with scissors and paste them together in a different form. They also tend to be older. Most young writers are learning to compose at a keyboard, and they cannot imagine another way to write. Neither can I—though on occasion I go back to my pencil for pages at a time. ***(The author state different people have different writing process and we should find the writing process suitable for us)***
14. The main thing is to keep at it. B. F. Skinner has pointed out that if you write only fifty words a night, you will produce a good - sized book every two or three years. That's not a bad record for any writer. William Faulkner outlined the plot of his Nobel Prize - winning novel *A Fable* on a wall inside his house near Oxford, Mississippi. You can see it there to this day. Once he got the outline on the wall, he sat down with his typewriter and wrote, following the outline to the end. If writing an outline on a kitchen wall does the trick for you, do it. You can always repaint the wall if you must. ***(Say the significance of consistence during writing)***

15. Think of writing as a process making its way toward a product—sometimes painfully. Don't imagine you must know everything you are going to say before you begin. Don't **demean** yourself and insult your readers by letting your first draft be your final draft. Don't imagine that writing is easy or that you can do it without spending time on it. And don't let anything stand in your way of doing it. Let your house get messy. Leave your magazines unread and your mail unanswered. Put off getting up for a drink of water or a cup of tea. Never mix alcohol with your writing; true, lots of writers have become alcoholics, but it has not helped their writing. Don't make a telephone call. Don't straighten up your desk. Sit down and write. And write, and write, and write. (*Summarize the suggestions and warnings for writing*)
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Significant Words and Phrases

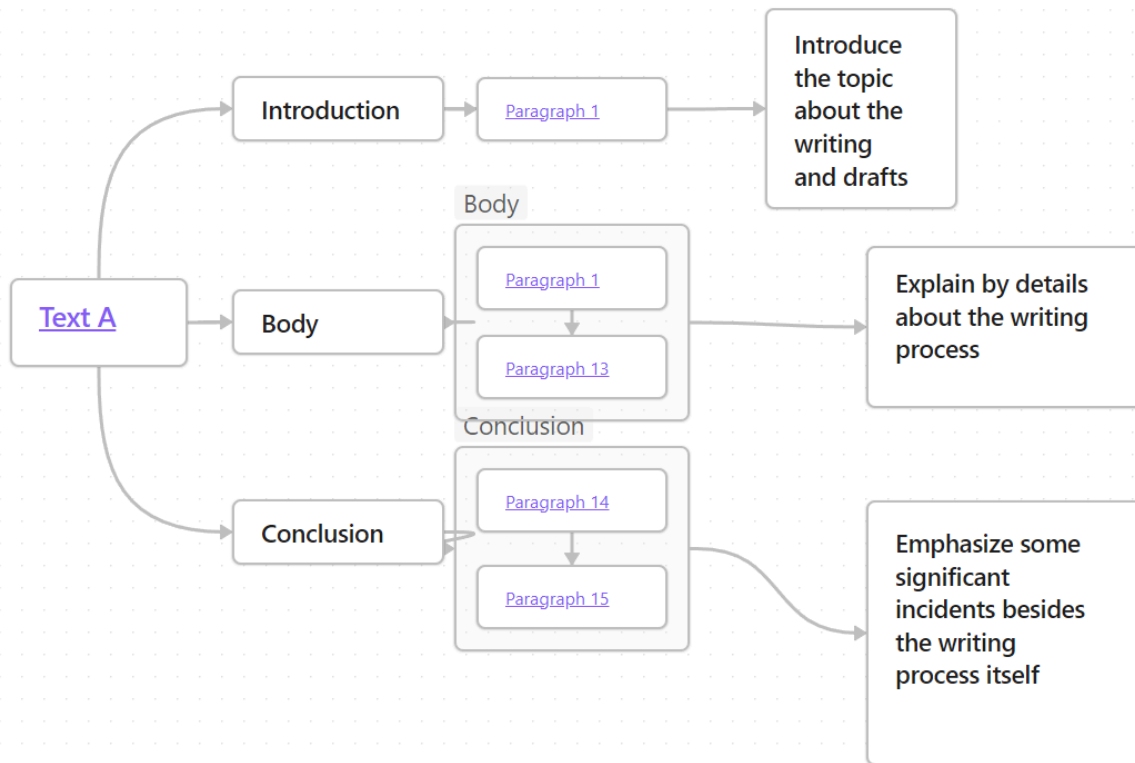
- elaborate #CET6
complex; work out in detail
- preliminary #CET4 #CET6
preceding preparation for something
- slave #CET4 #CET6
a person owned by someone
- revelation #CET4 #CET6
the truth that be healed; something surprising
- toss #CET4 #CET6
throw away
- cement #CET4 #CET6
concrete things; bind and join
- coherent #CET4 #CET6
capable of consistence and fluency
- advent #CET6
appearance
- smashing #CET6
great, excellent
- digress
take away from the right direction
- compelling #CET4 #CET6
force; convincing
- ramble
hang out

- play a bit
somewhat entertain
 - diskette
disk
 - prop #CET6
a column that support something others
 - prose #CET4 #CET6
ordinary writing
 - demean
reduce the worth or character
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Topic Idea

this article explains the steps to writing and revision by details and emphasize some significant thing when writing.

Structure



Activity 1

Task 2

Task 2 Marius writes 15 paragraphs to recommend a writing process, but this does not mean that the process should be necessarily broken down into 15 steps. While some paragraphs introduce steps in writing, others offer more explanation to the steps suggested in the preceding paragraphs. Make a list of the writing steps Marius suggests, including important tips for each step. The first step has been provided for you as an example. Compare your summary of the process with your partner's.

Step 1: Make a list outline

- Tips:
- 1) List main points
 - 2) Order is not important
 - 3) Revise it if necessary
 - ...

- Step 2: Begin to write the first draft.
 - Keep writing for at least one hour.
 - Focus on the fluency of writing.
 - Write down the new ideas when writing.
 - Don't erase all due to a revelation.
- Step 3: Revise in the second draft.
 - Reading the rough draft.
 - Changes radically if necessary.
 - Don't rely on the computers too much.
 - Delete unnecessary incidents and digression.

- Step 4: Proceed to the third draft.
 - Do some detailed revision.
 - Compare with former editions.
 - Find the appropriate writing process for ourselves.
 - Keep writing everyday.
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Activity 2

Task 1

Task 1 Think critically about the writing techniques used in Text A and discuss the following questions in groups.

1. An introductory paragraph usually raises a topic and gives a brief picture of the whole essay. However, in this essay, Marius just goes straight to the first main point (i.e., his first step) after a brief opening sentence. Do you find it rather abrupt? Or do you find it quite natural? Explain.
 2. Marius draws on several metaphors to help him describe the writing process. A
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typical one is found at the end of Paragraph 4 when he compares writing to sailing. What does he want to illustrate through this metaphor? What other metaphors can you find in this essay? Are they effective or not? Explain.

3. Marius admits in Paragraph 13 that his writing process may not work for everybody. Then why does he explain his process in careful detail? Does this admission weaken the power of this essay? Explain.
4. Marius uses his own experience as well as his friends' to explain his suggested process. He also makes reference to the experiences of great writers such as B. F. Skinner and William Faulkner. Does the use of different types of evidence make his argument more convincing? Why or why not?
5. Comment on the concluding sentence: "And write, and write, and write." Why does Marius repeat the word "write"? Explain.

- It is quite natural because the connect between the topic of writing draft and the first main point of it is extreme tight. If the they are divided into two paragraphs it will be tedious. Meanwhile, the author aims to introduce the writing draft and the method make the article more logical.
- He explains his process in details to share his experience of writing and make it as an example for readers to encourage readers to foster their own writing process. It does not weaken the power of this essay since the own writing process is also the necessary incident for writing drafts and the paragraph strengthen the power of this essay to teach readers how to write.

- The author repeat the word "write" to emphasize the readers' impression on the word and express the significance of keeping writing.